

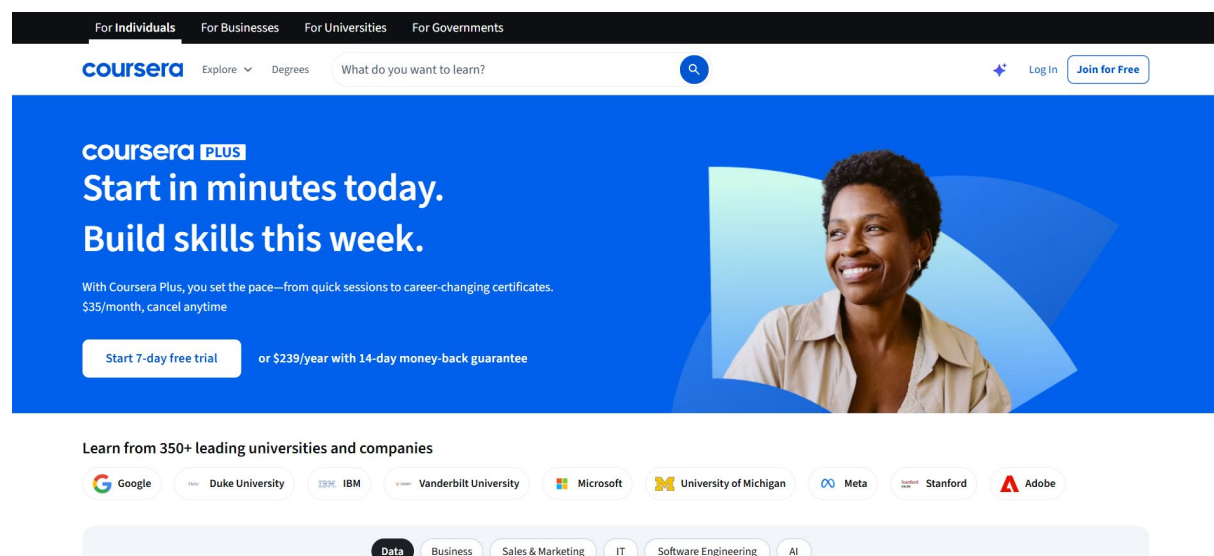
Coursera UX Report

Introduction

Coursera is an online learning website that provides a platform for taking academic courses. It is being evaluated as an active online learning platform. The purpose of this UX report is to outline the customer experience, identify the strengths and weaknesses of the website and investigate instances that could be relate to the peak end-rule.

Website Overview

Coursera is designed to provide a means through which relevant courses are accessible to everyone. The main user goals of coursera are; finding a course, examining course information, enrolling/purchasing a course, beginning learning and tracking their progress in the course. There are many relevant customer-experience features such as; course browsing, course pages, enrolment procedures, progress tracking and course completion.



UX Study Method

There were four participants in this study. The testing methods used were the shortened UEQ questionnaire alongside a brief interaction with the coursera website. Some of the tasks given to the users for this study were; browsing for a course, opening a course and examining course information.

UEQ Results

obstructive	o o o ● o o o	supportive
complicated	o o o o o o ●	easy
inefficient	o o o o o o ●	efficient
confusing	o o o o ● o o	clear
boring	o o ● o o o o	exciting
not interesting	o ● o o o o o	interesting
conventional	o o o ● o o o	inventive
usual	o o ● o o o o	leading edge

Coursera scored highly in the criteria of being easy, efficient, and clear to use. Navigation and actual use if the website were easy to find, understand and make use of.

Coursera scored middlingly in the criteria of supportive and inventive. While the website itself is quite a commonly seen format, there are aspects that allow it to stand apart from its counterparts of the same nature in its course display and navigation bar.

Coursera scored lowly in excitement, interestingness, and leading edge/innovation. The website aims to fulfil the desired functions more than it does to reinvent how these kinds of course websites present themselves and function.

Peak-End Rule Analysis

Peak experience:

While viewing course information there is a negative response to the constant pop-ups and clutter that fills the page, instead of having only the desired information there is an ai assistant that while useful takes up half the screen, when scrolling down there is a bar that covers up more of the screen and there is a jumble of text that can confuse/divert attention away from the users goal. This stands out as it feels off putting to the user. This is a negative peak that will remain as a lasting memory in the users mind.

The screenshot displays the IBM Data Analytics with Excel and R Professional Certificate page. The page is cluttered with various elements, including a navigation bar, a 'Skills you'll gain' section with multiple tags, a 'Tools you'll learn' section, and a 'Details to know' section. A prominent chatbot overlay is visible on the right side, titled 'Your privacy and this chat', which contains a message about chat history and a 'Got it' button. Below the chatbot, there are several input fields for questions like 'How do I know if I'm ready?', 'What else should I be considering?', and 'I'm switching careers, where should I start?'. The overall layout is dense and distracting, which aligns with the negative peak experience described in the text.

The end of the experience gave confirmation of enrolment and gives access to the course as well as a progress bar. This is somewhat memorable as the user is shown how far they have come and “rewarded” in the sense that you are successfully enrolled.

Strengths and Weaknesses

Strengths:

- Clear navigation
- Easy to understand flow
- Clear end goal
- Extra features to help users make decisions

Weaknesses:

- Clutter on course pages
- Boring/usual layout
- Too much choice

Design Guidelines

Make important user actions noticeable visible. Provide clear feedback. Don't over pack any singular page with information/action. Make course completion feel significant. Give feedback wherever applicable. Differentiate important moments/actions from common ones. Create a final memorable interaction.

Conclusion

Coursera employs a somewhat standard layout and flow for academic websites. The peak of the website is the negative peak of the clutter and the end is when a user successfully enrolls into a course. By making use of the standard layout and elements if innovation our website can be positively influenced.